
ALPHALIZE TECHNOLOGIES

App User Manual

User Manual

Odoo 19 module that stores the mobile app's user-manual PDF documents in the database, so administrators can upload, replace, and remove them without shipping a new app build.

Module	app_user_manual
Version	19.0.1.0.0
Platform	Odoo 19 + React Native mobile app
Audience	Odoo administrators, app admins, and end users

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1. Introduction

App User Manual is a small Odoo 19 add-on that keeps the mobile app's user-manual PDF documents inside the Odoo database. Administrators upload, retitle, reorder, or remove documents from the Odoo backend (or from the app's own admin screen), and every device picks up the change automatically — without publishing a new app build.

Because the PDFs live in the database rather than being bundled into the app, the manual library can grow and change over time. Each record is one titled document; the app lists them all and fetches whichever one the user opens.

1.1 What the module adds

- A dedicated User Manual menu in the Odoo backend for managing manual documents.
- A new model, `app.user.manual`, where each record is one titled PDF with an upload field, an ordering handle, and an active toggle.
- A change log (chatter) on every document, so admins can audit who uploaded, replaced, or removed a manual and when.
- Two app-facing methods — `get_manuallys()` (the light list) and `get_manual(id)` (one document's bytes) — that the mobile app calls to show and open manuals.

1.2 How it works

The module stores documents; the mobile app reads them. The flow is:

1. An administrator adds a PDF document in Odoo (or from the app's admin screen), giving it a title.
2. The app calls `get_manuallys()`, which returns a light list of every active document that has a PDF — id, title, and filename only, without the bytes.
3. When a user taps a document, the app calls `get_manual(id)`, which returns that one PDF as a base64 string.
4. The app writes the PDF to a local cache file and opens or downloads it.

NOTE The manuals are served over RPC using the logged-in session, so there is no separate login. When the module is not installed the call errors and the app simply treats it as “no manuals available.” There is no bundled offline copy — the library is database-only.

1.3 Module summary

Property	Value
Technical name	<code>app_user_manual</code>
Display name	App User Manual
Version	<code>19.0.1.0.0</code>
Category	Tools
Author	Alphalze Technologies
License	LGPL-3
Dependencies	<code>base</code> <code>mail</code>

Property	Value
Model	app.user.manual
Type	Application (appears in the Odoo app drawer)

2. Installation

Installing the module is a standard Odoo add-on deployment. You need administrator access to the Odoo server and to the Odoo database.

2.1 Prerequisites

- An Odoo 19 instance that you can administer.
- The **Discuss / Mail** apps present (the `mail` dependency is part of a standard Odoo install).
- Server-level access to the Odoo add-ons directory, or permission to upload modules through the interface.
- The React Native mobile app, configured to connect to the same Odoo database (required for users to actually read the manuals in the app).

2.2 Deploy the module files

1. Stop the Odoo service before copying files, to avoid stale cached code:

```
net stop odoo
```

1. Copy the `app_user_manual` folder into your Odoo add-ons path. A typical Windows path looks like this:

```
C:\Program Files\Odoo 19\server\odoo\addons\app_user_manual
```

1. If you are replacing an earlier copy of the module, delete the old `app_user_manual` folder completely first, then copy in the fresh files. Do not merge folders.
2. Start the Odoo service again:

```
net start odoo
```

IMPORTANT On Windows, Odoo can keep running old code from cached bytecode files after an update. If the module behaves unexpectedly after an upgrade, stop the service, delete the module folder entirely, copy the fresh files, and only then upgrade from the Apps menu.

2.3 Install from the Apps menu

1. Log in to Odoo as an administrator.
2. Open the **Apps** menu.
3. Click **Update Apps List** (you may need to enable developer mode to see this option). Confirm the update.
4. Search for **App User Manual**.
5. Click **Activate** (or **Install**) on the module card.

Odoo installs the module along with its dependencies. Once finished, a new User Manual entry appears in the app drawer.

2.4 Verify the installation

After installation, confirm everything is in place:

- The **User Manual** app appears in the main Odoo menu.

- Opening it shows the document list with an *Add your first manual document* placeholder (empty on a fresh install).
- You can create a record, type a title, and upload a PDF without error.

TIP If the User Manual menu shows a generic placeholder icon instead of a custom one, that is expected. The module ships without an icon image, and Odoo simply uses a default tile. The menu still works normally.

3. The Manual Document Fields

Each manual document is one record on the User Manual document form. The fields are:

The screenshot shows a web form for managing manual documents. The form is titled 'User Manual' and has a 'New' button. The fields are: Title (Hilal Khamis Najan Manual), Manual PDF (Hilal Khamis Najan Manual.pdf), Sequence (10), and Active (checked). There are icons for edit, download, and delete next to the Manual PDF field. A 'Send message' button is visible on the right side of the form.

The User Manual document form — Title, Manual PDF, Sequence, and Active fields

Field	Type	Description
Title	Text (required)	The name users see for the document in the app — for example “Getting Started Guide.” Required.
Manual PDF	File	The PDF itself. Click to upload or replace; a download icon appears once a file is set. Stored as a database attachment.
Filename	Text	The original file name, kept automatically so downloads carry a sensible name. Hidden on the form.
Sequence	Number	Controls the order documents appear in. Drag the handle on the list to reorder; lower numbers come first.
Active	Yes / No	Uncheck to hide a document from the app without deleting it. Inactive documents are excluded from the app list.

NOTE Only **active** documents that actually have a PDF attached are returned to the app. A record with a title but no file, or one that has been archived, is skipped in the app’s list.

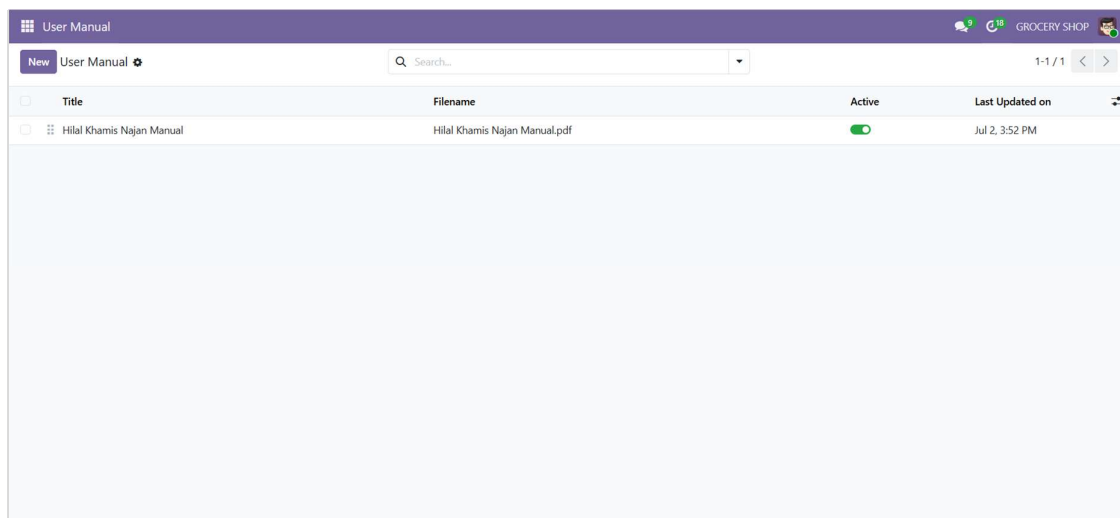
4. Using the Module

Once installed, the module is managed from Odoo and consumed in the mobile app. This section walks through both sides.

4.1 Adding a manual document (Odoo backend)

1. Open the **User Manual** app from the Odoo drawer.
2. Click **New**.
3. Type a **Title** — this is what users see in the app.
4. Click the **Manual PDF** field and upload the PDF file.
5. Optionally set the **Sequence** to control ordering, then **Save**.

The document is now live. The next time the app opens the User Manual, the new document appears in the list.



Title	Filename	Active	Last Updated on
Hilal Khamis Najan Manual	Hilal Khamis Najan Manual.pdf	☒	Jul 2, 3:52 PM

The User Manual list — the saved document with its filename, Active toggle, and last-update time

4.2 Replacing or removing a document

- To **replace** the PDF, open the document, click the **Manual PDF** field, and upload a new file. The title and position are kept.
- To **rename** it, edit the **Title** and save.
- To **remove** it from the app but keep it on file, untick **Active** (archive).
- To **delete** it permanently, use the list's **Delete** action.

TIP Every change is recorded in the document's chatter at the bottom of the form — title, file, and active status are all tracked, so you can see who changed what and when.

4.3 Ordering documents

The order in which documents appear in the app is set by the Sequence field:

1. Open the **User Manual** list.
2. Drag the handle (the small grip icon at the left of each row) up or down.
3. Release to drop the document into its new position. The order saves automatically.

4.4 Viewing manuals in the mobile app

For an end user, reading a manual is a couple of taps:

1. Open the app and go to **Profile** → **User Manual**.
2. Browse the list of available documents.
3. Tap a document, then choose **View** to read it or **Download** to save a copy.

NOTE The manual list an admin can also reach from **Home** → **Administration** → **User Manual**. Whether the row is shown to ordinary users is controlled per device by the admin's **Show to users** toggle.

4.5 Managing manuals from the app (admins)

Administrators do not have to switch to Odoo to manage documents. On the in-app User Manual screen, admins also see:

- An **Add** button to pick a PDF from the device and upload it as a new document.
- Per-row **edit** and **delete** controls to retile, replace, or remove a document.

Changes made in the app write straight to the same database records, so they show up in Odoo (and on every other device) immediately.

IMPORTANT Add / edit / delete controls appear only for administrators (the app checks the logged-in user). Ordinary users see a read-only list with **View** and **Download** only.

5. Troubleshooting

Most issues come down to one of two things: a document was not set up completely in Odoo, or the module was not deployed cleanly. The table below covers the common cases.

Symptom	What to check
App shows “Manual not available” or an empty list	Confirm at least one document is Active and has a PDF attached. Confirm the app is connected to the same Odoo database the module is installed on. Confirm the module shows as Installed in the Apps menu.
A document is missing from the app	Check that the record is Active (not archived). Check that a PDF is actually attached — a title alone is not enough.
User Manual menu is missing after install	Re-open the Apps menu and confirm the module shows as Installed. Run Update Apps List and try installing again. Refresh the browser; the app drawer is cached client-side.
Admin cannot add / edit in the app	Only administrators see the add / edit / delete controls. Confirm the logged-in user is an Odoo administrator.
Module behaves oddly right after an upgrade	This is usually stale cached code on Windows. Stop the Odoo service, delete the whole module folder, copy the fresh files, restart the service, then upgrade from the Apps menu.
User Manual icon looks generic / placeholder	Expected behaviour. The module ships without an icon image, so Odoo shows a default tile. No action needed.

Appendix A: Quick Reference

Where to find things

I want to...	Go to
Add or manage manual documents	Odoo → User Manual app → New
Reorder documents	User Manual list → drag the row handle
Hide a document without deleting	Open the document → untick Active
Read a manual (end user)	App → Profile → User Manual → tap → View
Add a manual from the app (admin)	App → User Manual screen → Add
Reinstall or upgrade the module	Apps menu → search “App User Manual”

Deployment commands (Windows)

```
:: stop the Odoo service before swapping module files
net stop odoo

:: (delete the old module folder, copy in the fresh one)

:: start the service again
net start odoo
```

At a glance

Item	Detail
Module	app_user_manual
Version	19.0.1.0.0
Model	app.user.manual
Fields	Title, Manual PDF, Filename, Sequence, Active
Multiple documents?	Yes — one titled PDF per record
Storage	Odoo database (attachments); no bundled offline copy
Managed by	Odoo admins (backend) and app admins (in-app)
Depends on	base mail